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React forwardRef

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What is forwardRef?

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`forwardRef` lets your component pass a reference to one of its children. It's like giving a direct reference to a DOM element inside your component.

Common uses for `forwardRef`:

- Focusing input elements
- Triggering animations
- Measuring DOM elements
- Integrating with third-party libraries

Basic Example

Here's a simple example of forwarding a ref to an input element:

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```
import { forwardRef, useRef } from 'react';

const MyInput = forwardRef((props, ref) => (
  <input ref={ref} {...props} />
));

function App() {
  const inputRef = useRef();

  const focusInput = () => {
    inputRef.current.focus();
  };

  return (
    <div>
      <MyInput ref={inputRef} placeholder="Type here..." />
      <button onClick={focusInput}>Focus Input</button>
    </div>
  );
}
```

Run Example »

In this example:

- We wrap our input component with `forwardRef`
- The component receives a `ref` as its second parameter
- The parent can now control the input element directly

Note: Only use `forwardRef` when you need direct access to a DOM element. For most cases, you can use props and state instead.

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